

Fathers of the Kingdom

Then the king said, “ Is there not still someone of the house of Saul, to whom I may show the kindness of God? And Ziba said to the king, “There is still a son of Jonathan who is lame in his feet.” (2 Samuel 9:3).

"And Jonathan the son of Saul had a crippled son. He was five years old when the news of the death of Saul and Jonathan came from Jezreel, and his nurse took him and fled; And as she hurried away, the child fell, and was lame. His name was Mephibosheth “(2nd Samuel 4:4).

Mephibosheth was born into a royal family, his grandfather Saul was the King and his father Jonathan was the Prince.

Mephibosheth was third in line to take the throne and reign over Israel.

We could say that Mephibosheth was not just any child, he was a child with a purpose, a child with a destiny and a bright future.

But at the age of only five, his bright future was cut off in a day.

In one day he loses his grandfather and his father. If this were not enough, he is also living with the ravages of abandonment and the absence of a father in the home.

We are not pastoring churches, we are running orphanages

He would never again feel the affection of his father, he would never again hear his voice, and never again would he sit at the feet of his grandfather the King.

To add sadness to his pain, this innocent child could never be in mourning for his father because he had to leave his land as he was carried away.

NURSE DROPPED HIM— CRIPPLED

The Bible says, that Mephibosheth fell from the hands of his nurse, because as she fled, she dropped him and his fall left him crippled at the feet.

Trauma inflicted by being dropped by family and being dropped by the church

At that moment, when he needed the most comfort, his nurse allowed this five-year-old boy who just lost his grandfather and father in one day, to slip from her hands and suffer a fall.

EMOTIONAL PAIN AND PHYSICAL PAIN

Since then, Mephibosheth would suffer emotional pain for the loss of his father and physical pain from his crippled legs and feet.

Mephibosheth, would never again walk the same way in life. He would forever carry an external sign on his body, because of the absence of a father and the negligence of a nurse.

Due to his escape, Mephibosheth no longer possessed anything to identify himself with his royal family.

His father left him no inheritance, left him no land, left him no possessions, he remained orphaned and without a fatherly inheritance.

DIFFERENT FATHER FIGURES IN OUR LIFE

This tragedy in the story of Mephibosheth's life, reveals to us, that there will always be different father figures in our lives.

This story shows four father figures:

- Mentor Fathers
- Coach Fathers
- Substitute Fathers
- and Spiritual Fathers.

When we ask someone to be for spiritual paternity – You
are inviting them to
Say what they want to
When they want to
How they want to
And we give up the right to be offended

In this story reveals four important characters:

- Saul,
- Jonathan,
- Machir, (May-Kear)
- and David,

All were key people in the life of Mephibosheth.

Each of these characters took a role and a position in the life of Mephibosheth.

King Saul – Mentor Father

Saul as the grandfather of Mephibosheth, in this case, represented the Mentor Father.

Because a grandfather's role is to be a mentor and at the same time identify the talents and skills that his grandchildren possess.

A Mentor is the person who educates, advises and guides, but at the same time does not have the ability to discipline because of their feelings toward the grandchild.

The grandfather (Mentor Father) prefers to support the mistakes of the grandson rather than disciplining him, because in this way he does not run the risk of losing his relationship with the grandson.

Saul's role as a Mentor Father in the life of Mephibosheth was to identify and develop his talents in order to prepare him in the principles of the Kingdom.

Jonathan the Prince- Coach Father

Jonathan as the biological father of Mephibosheth represents the Coach Father. **This word coach is better known as the word "Trainer".**

The role of the biological father is to train or instruct the child.

“Train up a child in the way he should go, And when he is old he will not depart from it” (Proverbs 22:6).

The word train here means to narrow down the path that the child travels – Ruts – Living a certain way for a long time – My dad, everyone is doing it – A coach will get in your grill

Only those who run in a race need to be trained. It should be noted that **Mephibosheth ends up crippled while his nurse ran outside the palace.**

The absence of the trainer (Coach Father) in the child's life, caused his way or purpose to be hindered.

If we don't have a coach we are not on a team. All kingdom purpose is accomplished through team effort.

Another version of the same scripture says it this way
“Direct your children onto the right path, and when they are older, they will not leave it”
NLT).

It is important to note, that the scripture specifically says
the child should be trained in his own path, not in his father's path.

We have the propensity to send everyone down the same path – The scripture say's we are to train them up in the way THEY SHOULD go, not the way we want them to go – Sending them down the road THEY SHOULD go is impossible until they know what their purpose is

Note: as spiritual parents....Our desire is to help you find your path. And co mission you.

Once you find your mission we walk with you on that mission.

The biological fathers job, is to train his son and then let him run in the path (course) that the son chooses.

We are going to CO-MISSION you – we are not going to do this for you – we are going to walk your path with you

Here there path - Nick

With that said, how does a biological father train his son?

The father trains through discipline. Discipline is another form of training.

The discipline of the father forms character and temperament, it teaches the child how to stay on the course even when his strength is running out.

Correct discipline ensures success for every athlete. If you want to ensure success for your children, do not cease the discipline in their lives.

Discipline vs. punishment

If I had to do it over I would whip less and teach more

If we can't be called out, we shouldn't be stood up
We cannot allow discipline by a father to cause us to
become a martyr – We should be able to be disciplined by
a father and then to break bread with the father

Richard Vega – When I ask him to do something he does
it and never becomes a martyr

If we can't endure discipline we are a bastard son

IN ONE DAY- Lose of mentor and coach.

In one day, Mephibosheth loses his Mentor and his
Coach, and **when we do not have a Mentor
Father or a Coach Father, we end up in the
hands of a Nurse which is symbolic of the
Church (or organizations).**

**In the Hands of a Nurse Symbolic of the Church
When we do not have a mentor father or coach
father, we can end up in the hands of a nurse...
which is symbolic of: This can be the church,
institutions, organizations, denominations.**

The nurse is someone who cares for a child just for gain and reward. All about what you can do for me...not what I as a spiritual father/mother can do for you.

A nurse is a hired gun

Mephibosheth's nurse represents the church, that **when under pressure ends up letting you fall.**

When the nurse heard that King Saul and Jonathan were dead, she took Mephibosheth into her hands and fled, but as **she fled, she dropped him.**

Hired guns run from the situation when the pressure is on, parents run to the trauma – No soldier left behind – If you fight one of us, you have to fight the whole family

This is a present truth, because usually people in the church run under pressure. They will let you down so that they themselves are saved.

How many people outside the church are spiritually paralyzed and lame, because one

day they trusted in a (church) system that let them fall?

Mephibosheth relied on a church/system to take care of him, but unfortunately he was disappointed.

If we make the same mistake of putting our trust alone in a church/system, we also can end up wounded and on the crippled floor of our expectations and failures.

Terrorist in the church -

I must mention, that not all Nurses (Churches) are the same, but this time it was Mephibosheth who had a nurse that dropped him.

The reason she dropped him, was because she never carried him on the inside, she only carried him on the outside.

She never conceived Miphiboseth, she never gave birth to him, nor did she travail in labor

for Mephibosheth, so for this reason she let him fall.

She was quick in carrying him, but weak in sustaining him.

How many people have ended up falling for putting their trust in a system, or in a congregation?

As a Pastor I must tell you, that your trust should be in God and in the Leaders that God has set before you. But as human as our leaders are, they too can be prone to failing us and dropping us along the way.

ITS ABOUT THE KINGDOM NOT A CHURCH OR A SYSTEM

Therefore, do not just worry about being part of an organization (Church), worry about being part of the body of Christ (Kingdom).

Now, Mephibosheth was alive, but still crippled at his feet and without a Fatherly covering.

Every Ministry and Church needs the paternal covering of a Father.

Fathers vs. Politicians

Fathers go the distance – Politicians will abandon you when you become politically toxic

Fathers will take a bullet for you – Politicians will ghost you if they have to spend any leadership capital on you

How many ministries at this time, are spiritually crippled and stagnant, because they do not want to be covered by a Spiritual Father?

What we are running is not churches, but orphanages.

PH & SG students have an orphan spirit. They got dropped somewhere along the way.

They've never had a father covering. All of us have to have a father covering.

If you are tired of being spiritually crippled, be sure to find a Father who can guide you effectively in the ministry.

Mephibosheth was part of the Kingdom, he belonged to the palace, but he had no fatherly covering.

Machir

For being lame at his feet, he ended up with one named Machir (May-kear) living in Lodebar (2nd Samuel 9:5).

Machir- Substitute Father

Machir represents the substitute father, because **a substitute is the copy of something original.**

Don't settle for Substitute Leaders, because you can never inherit from the loins of a Substitute Father.

The substitute father does not have the child's DNA.

Substitute fathers will allow what legitimate fathers will never allow

No matter how much the substitute wants to impart on the son, the son will never be like him, because he does not have his DNA.

My dad's dogs – I don't look like him but I sound like him

You may not look like your spiritual parents but you should sound like them

Perhaps you inherited sons from another father and ended up being a substitute father to them, and sometimes no matter how much you raise them, instruct them and train them, they will never recognize you as a legitimate father.

Dave Deerman – The step kids didn't choose you, you chose them

So, if they have the spiritual DNA of another leader or pastor, but they want your spiritual DNA too, what do we do in this situation?

If they want your spiritual DNA, they will have to do as Jesus told Nicodemus: "You must be born again to see the Kingdom" (John 3:3).

Christ was not talking about returning to the womb of a mother - which represents being begotten by a Church.

Christ was saying- You have to be re-born by a Father. Therefore, if they want your DNA, they have to be begotten by you.

I had a pastor who asked me to be his spiritual father – I agreed to do so – We began walking together and the ministry he was leading began to flourish – Within a short time he began going in a different direction and his ministry stagnated at best and declined.

So how do you beget someone spiritually? If a person wants your DNA, he has to be willing to be born again. Now, I am not talking about salvation, I am talking about being begotten in the vision of a Spiritual Father, in order to be able to see the kingdom of God that he is establishing.

As long as they are not begotten by a Spiritual Father they will not be able to see what that Spiritual Father is seeing in the spiritual world.

When I say begotten, I speak in the spirit. **For that person to join to your spirit... That person will have to enter and join your spirit, they must know your heart, your mind and your character and after they know all this of you, would they still be willing to submit?**

If spiritually they don't get inside of you, they will never be able to see as you do, speak as you speak, think as you think, nor love the ministry and souls as you love them.

Someone who is begotten, is someone who must be born in the vision from the inside out.

If they are not willing to go inside and join themselves to you in the spirit, then they cannot be your sons, and if they fail to be your sons they will only end up being members of the Church.

They have to be RE gENEEd.

People who come under you...a process. Where you help them think, act, perform different.

Example: Mike Vecchio.

A genius at rehabilitation ministry.

Don is the CEO

Never in drug addiction.

I always start with Yes.

Walk through doors until doors closes.

Mike will be my replacement one day.

But he always starts with no.

But I have helped regene his thinking.

To start saying yes.

When you come under a spiritual father, you have to be willing to be regened or be willing to be trained to think differently than in the past.

You can't sit on sideline waiting for the old man to retire or die...you have to learn to think like your spiritual father so that there is no whiplash.

MEMBERS DO NOT INHERIT

The problem of just being a member, is that members do not inherit.

The inheritance of a house is only for the sons of that house.

Therefore, it is time to leave the house of Machir which represent the Substitute Fathers.

Machir lived in Lodebar - this represents a place, house or system that does not produce.

LO DEBAR

Debir (spelled differently, but scholars believe it's the same word) whose name means "pasture or sheepfold..."

It was one of the cities of Canaan, that Joshua destroyed in Joshua 10:39.

It was located near the valley of Achor...

Debar normally means “word” or “thing.”
The prefix LO is a negator.

Thus, the term Lo Debar would mean “no word or no thing;
without a place to feed, without pastures”

He's royalty
Belongs in the palace
Third in line for the kingdom
Is living where there is no word
No place to feed.
Without pasture.

Mephibosheth was 5 years old when this happened.
Lives in the palace.
3rd in line to be king
Was being educated by the best
Has a fall
Winds up in a place where there is a lack of everything.
His life hangs in one dramatic moment.
because of no father.
He's no longer royalty
No longer a way to support himself.
Dependent upon relatives to take care of him for the rest
of his life.
Or to beg.
In one dramatic moment that shifted everything.

LODEBAR: Lo is the primary particle of prohibition. It's
used in prohibitive commands...like:
Thou shalt not.

And is non negotiable.

that's the word lo.

It also serves as the particle of exclusion.

Which absolutely negates whatever follows the word LO...

Here it is LO Debar...which means word.

No word

No prophetic word

No thing

It negates whatever follows it.

As in "not my people"...it actually means "absolutely not my people."

When you put that word LO there.

That name may or may not have been an apt description of the town. If it was an apt description, it may have been lacking good pasture, or it may have been an insignificant, "nothing town." In English we might say that it was in the middle of nowhere.

People who don't have a spiritual father/parent/covering end up in the middle of nowhere, in a hot mess.

THIS WAS THE HIDING PLACE OF MEPHIBOSHETH.

No word

No thing

Nothing to eat

No place to feed

No pasture

Sounds like starvation to me.

Lo Debar.
He was royalty
3rd in line for kingdom
Belongs in the palace
And he is living where there is no place to feed.
No pastures
No word.

**Lodebar represents a system and mentality
that keeps you crippled and limited.**

**It is a place that does not develop your
potential, nor does it enable you for your
Purpose and Destiny.**

**Lodebar is the place that limits you because it
tolerates you.**

Go where you are celebrated not where you are tolerated

**You do not need someone who only tolerates you,
you need someone who celebrates and
encourages you to fulfill your dreams.**

**LAME ON HIS FEET
He's royalty.**

**He's 3rd in line to the throne.
He belongs in the palace.
There is an unrealized inheritance for him.
But he's hiding in Lodebar.**

“There is still a son of Jonathan who is lame in his feet.” (2nd Samuel 9:3).

**(((Jonathan means: Yahweh has given...
Yah...the shortened name of Yahweh.
And
Natan...**

The verb Natan...means to give from regular giving or bestowing, to setting or putting, to transforming one thing or situation into another)))

You could read this verse... there's still a son that Yahweh has given who is lame in his feet.

The important thing about Mephibosheth was that his fall did not destroy him, but it preserved him!

What the enemy meant to destroy you with may very well be exactly what God uses to sustain you – Not that they mean to, but oftentimes hostile actors push us into the will of God, when we are not capable of finding it on our own – Send thank you cards!

"There is still a son."

The best spiritual sons are those who have been preserved by a fall.

Perhaps they are spiritually crippled, but they are people who still exercise their potential despite their inability.

Mephibosheth was still able to function with his condition. Although he was crippled, they still called him a son.

A son, is not someone who has to be perfect, a son is someone who is connected to the spiritual DNA of his father.

A son is not someone who has been perfected

in the vision, a son is simply recognized by the DNA that he carries.

When King David hears and understands that there remains a son of Jonathan who is crippled at the feet, he still sends for him.

A father never recognizes you by your fall, he recognizes you by your destiny

Despite Mephibosheth's condition, David the King says, "Where is he?" (2nd Samuel 9:4).

It is here that Mephibosheth for the first time starts his encounter with a Spiritual Father.

David- A Spiritual Father

The role and main function of a Spiritual Father is to introduce you to the Kingdom.

Even though King David knew Mephibosheth was lame at the feet, he still brought him out of Lodebar.

A true Spiritual Father will still ask for you, knowing your weakness and frailty.

The relationship with a spiritual father will do three things:

Access -

Exposure

Dialogue

Because true spiritual fathers love their sons, even though their sons walk in God is not perfect.

The only way to end a relationship with me is for you to walk away

David was a Father in the Kingdom who understood his position as King and as Father.

We must then, be willing to raise up spiritual sons who have been injured by the (nurses) systems that dropped you.

The truth is this, there was nothing that Mephibosheth could give David, but David still called for him.

Spiritual fathers never recruit sons – Spiritual fathers never enter the relationship thinking of what benefit is in it for them – If they come to the relationship for what is in it for them, the relationship will turn abusive very quickly

This helps us to understand, that a true spiritual father does not focus on your problem but rather on your potential.

David the Father of the Kingdom said of Mephibosheth: "He is crippled but he has potential, he also shall be part of the kingdom."

This is **the difference** between a spiritual father and a substitute father, because **Spiritual Fathers have a Kingdom mentality**, while Substitute Fathers have a Church mentality.

Do not settle for a substitute when there is a Father in the Kingdom that awaits you.

"He came to David and fell face down and laid himself down in respect." (2nd Samuel 9: 6).

You will know that the lame person from Lodebar has potential to be a spiritual son, because, even though he is crippled he still knows how to get on his face and worship the King.

There are upright people who do not worship.

Mephibosheth was crippled, but he still entered into the palace in the position of Worship.

What **Mephibosheth said to David... "Behold, your servant", notice that Mephibosheth was crippled and had lost a lot of things in life, but he still retained the willingness to serve.**

True spiritual sons are those who do not come looking for a position but with a willingness to serve, because they understand that leadership is not position, it is service.

Mephibosheth came to give and not to receive.

Spiritual son's walk in humility – God gave you two ears and one mouth – (My experience with young pastor who thought he was the smartest guy in the room – There is no room in the ministry for buttholeery

By Mephibosheth having a heart to serve, **King David declared, "And I will restore to you all the land of Saul your grandfather; and you shall eat bread at my table continually" (2nd Samuel 9:7).**

For being a son, God gave him what at the moment belonged to another. Lands that he never worked, were given to him and **everything that was his father's and grandfather's ended up being his.**

The king added; "and you shall eat bread at my table continually,"

Spiritual paternity should be entered into carefully, and should be treated as a life long relationship – NEVER should it be for as long as we agree – We will not know whether we are submitted until we disagree

There was a table that was prepared for him.

He went from no word, no place to feed, no pastures to a continual table.

This means, they had to make room at the table for the crippled son.

Maybe you do not look like the other sons of the house, but you can still sit at the table and eat with your spiritual father.

DEAD DOG MENTALITY.

“What is your servant, that you should look upon such a dead dog as I?” (2nd Samuel 9: 8).

It's not what people say about you that can hurt you, it's what you say about yourself that can limit you.

People's perception of you cannot hold you back, it's how you see yourself that can keep you stagnant.

This dead dog mentality was what kept Mephibosheth in Lodebar.

For Mephibosheth to be able to enter into the dimension of the Kingdom, this limited mentality had to change.

Therefore, sometimes we will have to work with people who bring with them a Lodebar mentality.

The work that corresponds to a Spiritual Father, is to transform these sons with a mentality of Lodebar and transition them to sons with a mentality of the Kingdom.

I have some spiritual children who have this mentality – I have tried to change it, but I can only do what they will permit – Therefore they have reached their lid, not their potential

(((our process for this ...freedom Weekend. And KLA... Identity and purpose))

Perhaps because of the circumstances that happened to you in the past you see yourself as a dead dog, but your Spiritual Father will always see you as a son of the King who has a position at the table.

ZIBA. To plant.

To station

**From the root word: plant, to stand, to take
ones stand, pillar or perfect.**

And the king called to Ziba, Saul's servant, and said to him, "I have given to your master's son all that belonged to Saul and to all his house.

You therefore, and your sons and your servants, shall work the land for him, and you shall bring in the harvest, that your master's son may have food to eat. But Mephibosheth your master's son shall eat bread at my table always."

Now Ziba had fifteen sons and twenty servants. Then Ziba said to the king, "According to all that my lord the king has commanded his servant, so will your servant do" (2nd Samuel 9:9:10,11).

Ziba is a type of Holy Spirit – David didn't know where Mephibosheth was but Ziba did – David didn't know Mephibosheth's condition but Ziba did - David didn't come for Mephibosheth but Ziba did – David made a place at his table, but Ziba executed the plan for Mephibosheth's forward motion!

Everyone at the table did not believe Mephibosheth should be sitting next to princes and kings because he was crippled.

But those at the table did not understand, that he actually had more right to the table than they did.

Mephibosheth's son... Micha.

“Mephibosheth had a young son whose name was Micha.”
(2nd Samuel 9:12).

Even the crippled and lame have the capacity to reproduce in the kingdom.

All the years that Mephibosheth was in Lodebar he never produced anything until he arrived at the Kingdom and found his spiritual covering.

Fatherhood is not just about procreation – It is about training for reigning – It is about making

sure sons eclipse what th spiritual parents have accomplished

Jess Vecchio. Came to us with a broken Ministry and leadership. She found her spiritual parents. We now have 8 centers in 5 states. All because of alignment. That ministry is greasy from the oil of alignment now. Out from under alignment it was dry. (Russell Hylton teaching yesterday.

When he understood the principle of Spiritual Fatherhood, it was then that he began to produce a son. In the same manner, for you to become a spiritual father, you will first have to be willing to be a spiritual son.

THE GOAL...

The Spiritual Father has a goal of making sure that you do not stay as a spiritual son, but that you also may one day become a Spiritual Father to others.

The Lord said to me – Discipleship has not occurred until you have reached someone and trained them, and they have reached someone and are in the process of training their disciple! Discipleship cannot occur until it is multigenerational.

The scripture tell us, that the son Mephibosheth begot was called "**Micah**" **which means "who is like Jehovah"**.

Watch this.....

A crippled son was still able to produce something that had a similarity to God.

The son that Mephibosheth produced was not like Lodebar, but he resembled Jehovah.

I declare that what you are going to produce at this stage of your life will not look like your past experience!

Even if you find yourself crippled like Mephibosheth, what will come out of you will not be crippled.

This is interesting, because although Mephibosheth was crippled, he still found a wife. Implying that Mephibosheth decided to love someone else, although for years he himself lacked the love of a true father.

“So, Mephibosheth dwelt in Jerusalem, for he ate continually at the king’s table. And he was lame in both his feet.” (2nd Samuel 9:13).

Mephibosheth never returned to Lodebar because his table was in the Kingdom.

Therefore, stay in the Kingdom, stay under spiritual covering, because you have nothing to look for in Lodebar.

If we can stay still long enough to be trained for reigning, God can give us a throne of our own.

All you need is in the table of the King. When you are seated at the table of the King, you eat what the King eats, because there is exclusive food at the King's table.

The Scripture ends by revealing the following; “And he was lame in both his feet”. (2nd Samuel 9:13).

This means that God never healed him of his weakness.

I come to tell you something that might surprise you:

"Perhaps God will never heal your weakness," because while Mephibosheth sat at the table, the mantle of the table covered his weakness.

David ordered Mephibosheth to sit at the table with him, because the role of the Spiritual Father is to teach you how to reign at the table in spite of your weakness.

Mephibosheth was crippled, but he was still sitting and reigning at the table.

Do not worry about your faults, weaknesses and your inadequacies, because **your Spiritual Father will teach you how to reign with your incapacity/inadequacies.**

Mephibosheth was crippled and stagnant because he had no paternal covering.

We all need a Spiritual Father who can take us out of Lodebar and introduce us to the Kingdom.

We need someone in our lives to whom we are held accountable, and from whom we can seek wise advice.

We need to honor a Father, because it is the first commandment with promise (Exodus 20:12).

The different types of Fathers:

Mentor-Fathers

Coach-Fathers

Substitute-Fathers

and Spiritual-Fathers